



THE KENYA CONSUMER PRICE INDEX AND INFLATION REPORT

Released on: 31st August 2026

CONTACT PERSON:

Macdonald G. Obudho, PhD, EBS, MBS

Director General

 directorgeneral@knbs.or.ke; info@knbs.or.ke

 ; +254(20)2911000/1; +254(20)3317612/22/23/51



Table of Contents

Overview.....	1
The Overall CPI and Inflation Trends, August 2025 – August 2026	1
Movement of National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities	6
Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation	9
Contribution of Core and Non-Core to the Overall Inflation	9

List of Tables

Table 1: One and Twelve-Month Percentage Changes in the Consumer Price Indices....	3
Table 2: Key Drivers of Inflation for each of the 13 Divisions.....	5
Table 3: National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities	7
Table 4: Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation	9
Table 5: Core and Non-Core Contributions, August 2026	10

List of Figures

Figure 1: Overall CPI, August 2025 – August 2026.....	2
Figure 2: Inflation Trends, August 2025 – August 2026	2
Figure 3: Percentage Changes in CPI Across the 13 Divisions, July 2026 – August 2026	4
Figure 4: Percentage Changes in CPI Across the 13 Divisions, August 2025 – August 2026	5
Figure 5: Percentage Change in National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities, July 2026 – August 2026.....	8

Overview

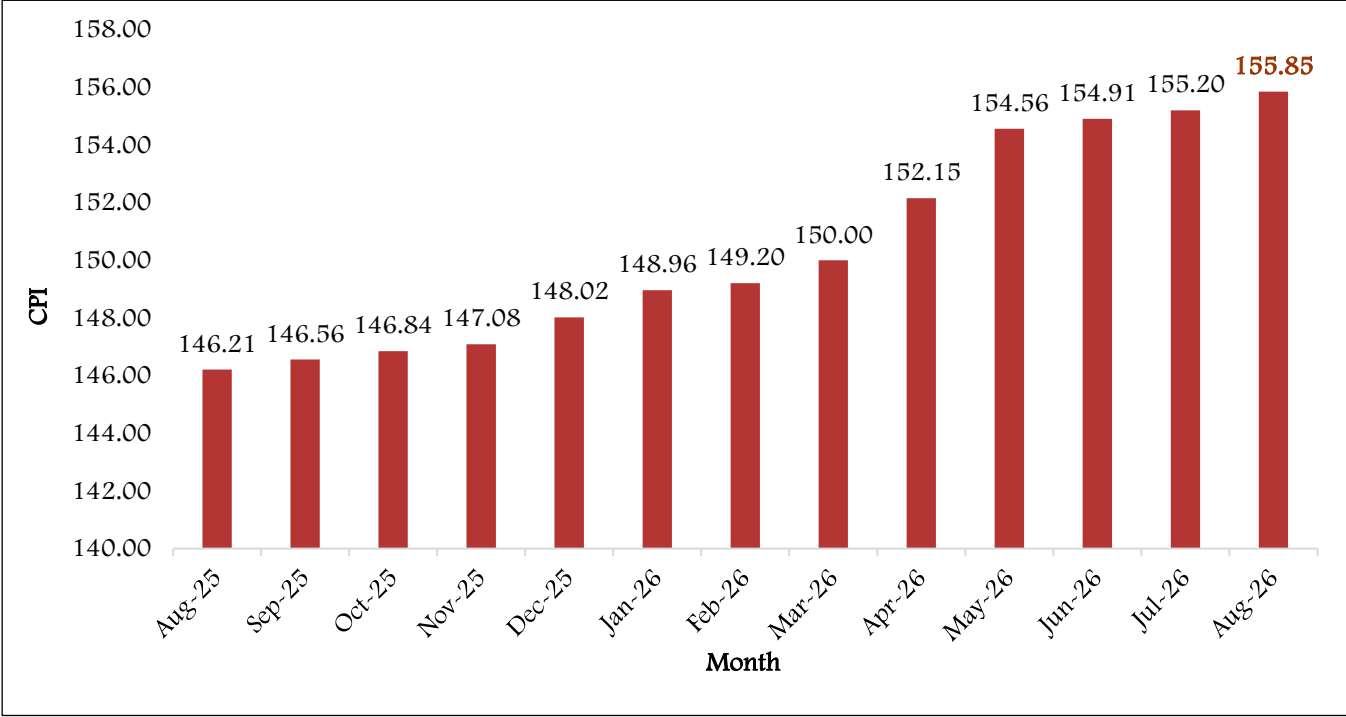
Annual consumer price inflation was 6.6 per cent in August 2026, as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI).#This implies that the general price level was 6.6 per cent higher in August 2026 than it was in August 2025. The price increase was primarily driven by a rise in prices of items in the Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages (9.0%); Transport (15.7%), and Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and other fuels (3.6%) over the one-year period. These three divisions together account for over 57 per cent of the total weight across the 13 major expenditure categories.

Consumer Price Index (CPI) is defined as a measure of the weighted aggregate change over time in retail prices paid by consumers for a given basket of goods and services. The CPI measures the cost of purchasing this fixed basket of goods and services, comparing current prices to those of a base period, which for the current CPI is February 2019. Inflation rate is defined as a percentage change of the CPI between two periods. There are different inflation rates that can be computed, such as annual (year-on-year), quarterly (quarter-to-quarter) and monthly (month-on-month) inflation rates. Data used to derive the inflation rates is collected through a monthly survey of retail prices from a statistically representative sample of outlets in urban areas across 50 data collection zones nationwide. The survey is conducted during the second and third weeks of the month.

The Overall CPI and Inflation Trends, August 2025 – August 2026

As presented in Figure 1, the overall index increased from 155.20 in July 2026 to 155.85 in August 2026, resulting in a monthly inflation rate of 0.4 per cent. The year-on-year inflation stood at 6.6 per cent in August 2026 as shown in Figure 2.

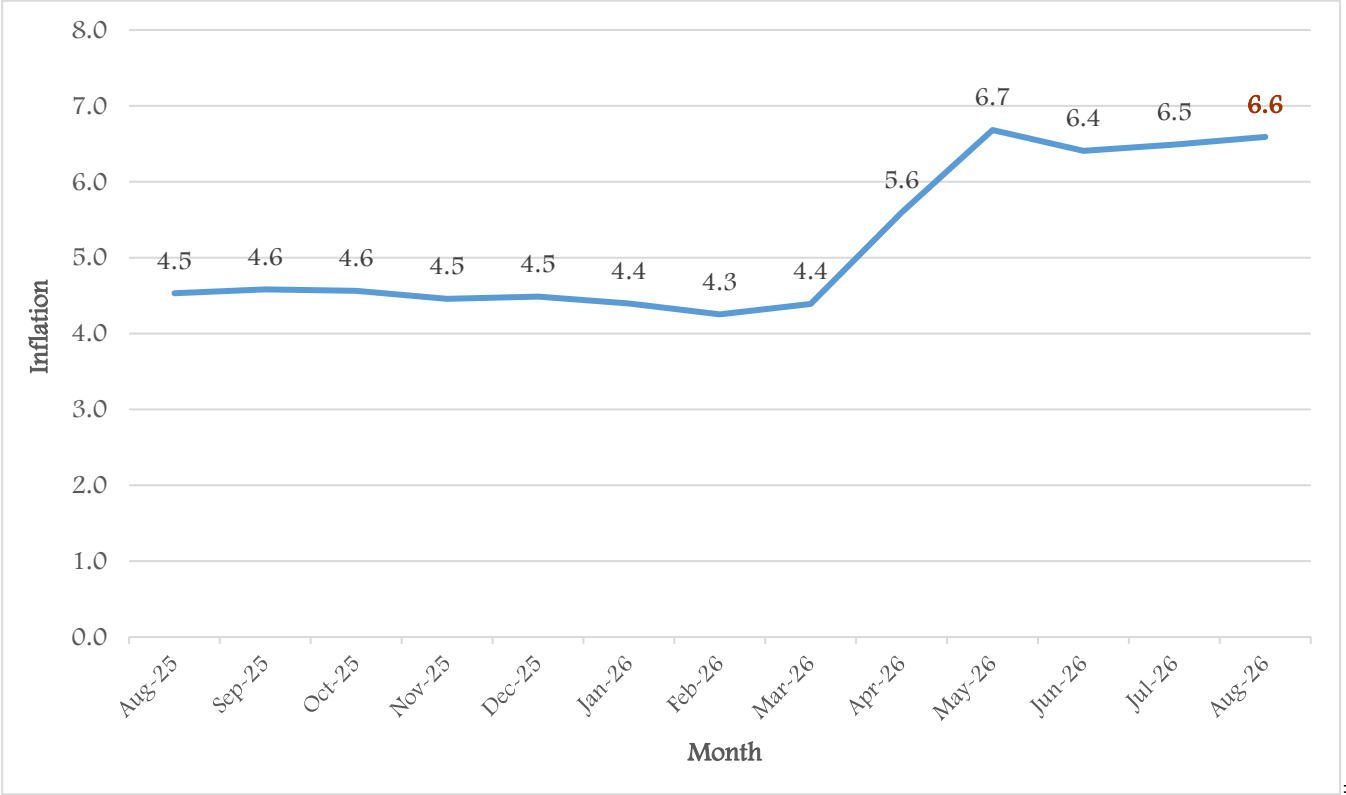
Figure 1: Overall CPI, August 2025 – August 2026



#

#

Figure 2: Inflation Trends, August 2025 – August 2026



#

Table 1: One and Twelve-Month Percentage Changes in the Consumer Price Indices

13 COICOP Divisions	Weight %	% Change on last month (August 2026 / July 2026)	% Change on same month of the previous year August 2026 / August 2025)
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	32.9094	0.6	9.0
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	3.3289	0.1	2.6
Clothing and Footwear	2.9914	0.1	2.2
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	14.6124	0.1	3.6
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance	3.7372	0.3	2.9
Health	2.9116	0.1	2.8
Transport	9.6468	0.7	15.7
Information and Communication	7.7840	0.4	0.8
Recreation, Sport and Culture	1.7219	1.0	3.6
Education Services	5.5620	0.0	2.9
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	8.0991	0.2	3.0
Insurance and Financial Services	2.2423	0.4	1.2
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services	4.4532	0.2	2.4
Total	100.0000	0.4	6.6

#

#

#

#

Figure 3: Percentage Changes in CPI Across the 13 Divisions, July 2026 – August 2026

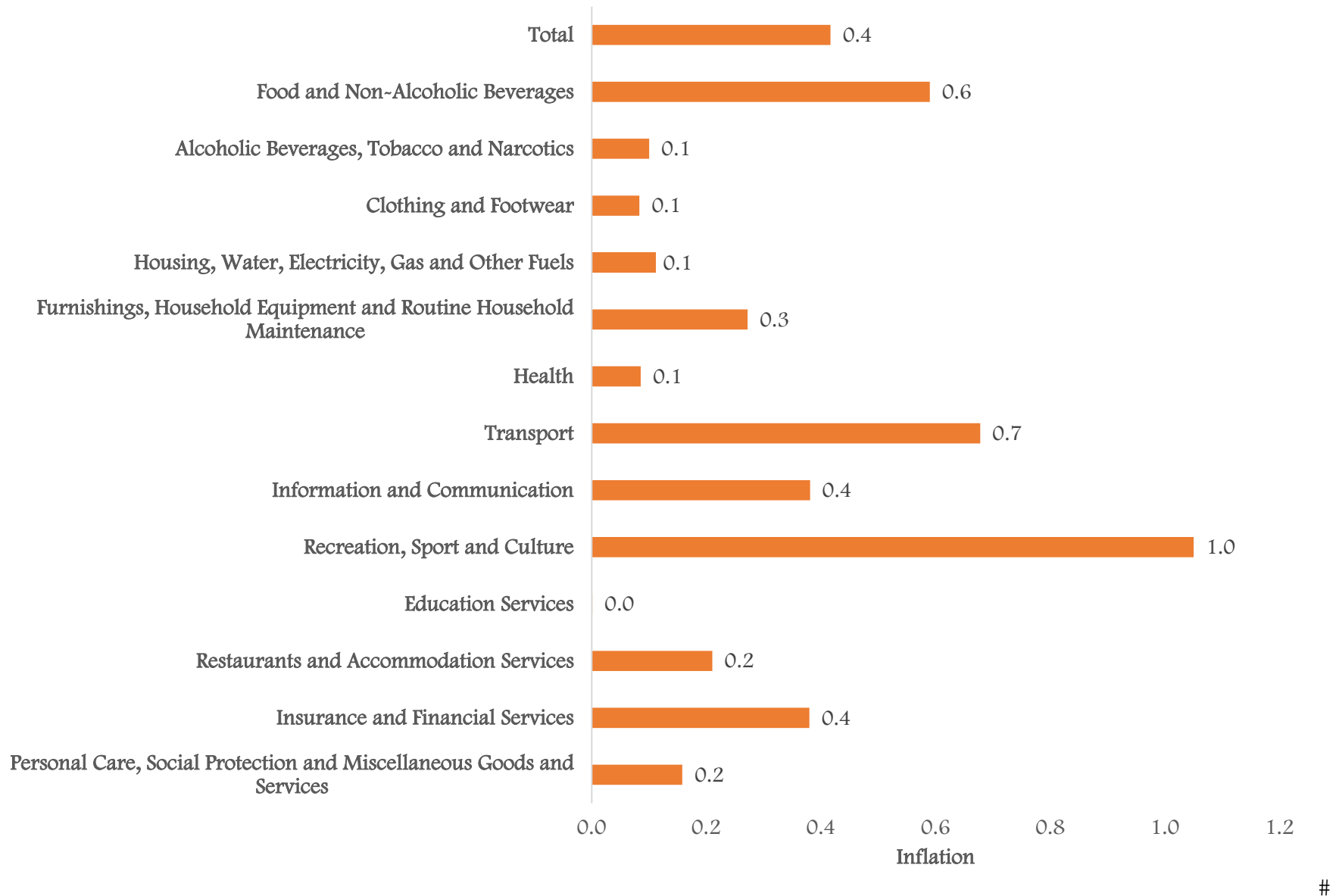
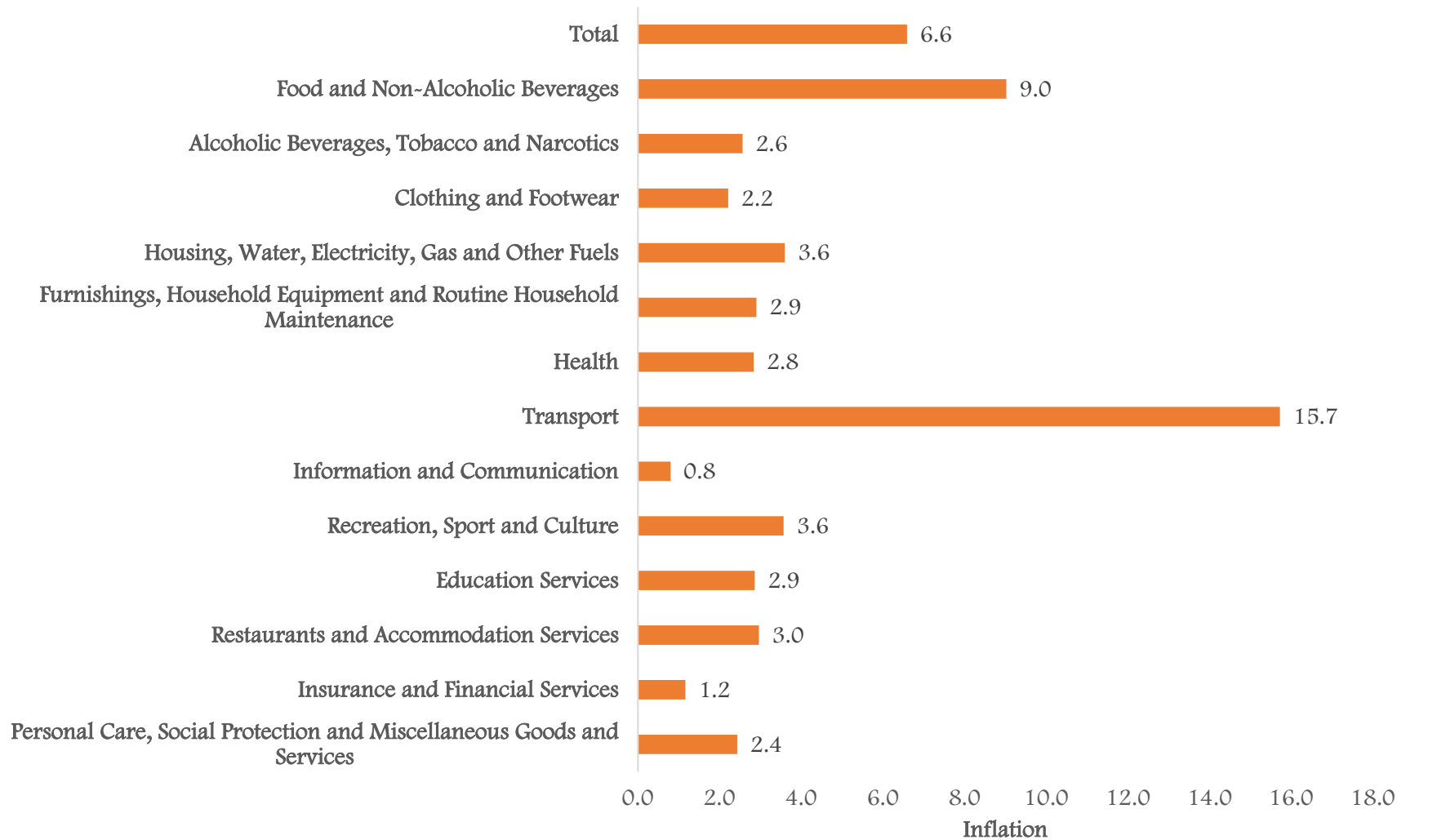


Figure 4: Percentage Changes in CPI Across the 13 Divisions, August 2025 – August 2026



#

#

#

#

Table 2: Key Drivers of Inflation for each of the 13 Divisions

Monthly		Yearly
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages		
 0.6%	Between July and August 2026, sifted maize flour prices recorded the largest decline, dropping by 2.7 per cent, followed closely by tomatoes, which fell by 2.2 per cent, and fortified maize flour, which eased by 2.0 per cent. On the other hand, several commodities saw price increases. Kale (Sukuma Wiki) recorded the sharpest rise at 4.3 per cent, followed by Irish potatoes at 4.1 per cent. Beef with bones also increased, though more modestly, by 1.2 per cent.	 9.0% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the prices under Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages division increased by 9.0 per cent.
Transport		
 0.7%	Between July and August 2026, diesel prices declined by 2.2 per cent. In contrast, transport-related services became more expensive over the same period. Local flight fares rose by 4.1 per cent while country bus and matatu fares for inter-town travel increased by 2.1 per cent.	 15.7% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the Transport division inflation rose to 15.7 per cent in August 2026.
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels		
 0.1%	Between July and August 2026, prices of gas/LPG recorded a slight decline of 0.2 per cent. Meanwhile, prices of electricity (200kWh) and charcoal both saw small increases, rising by 0.2 per cent and 0.4 per cent, respectively.	 3.6% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the general price level of items under the division rose by 3.6 per cent.
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics		
 0.1%	Between July and August 2026, the price of Wine prices rose slightly by 0.2 per cent. Miraa (khat), on the other hand, saw a more pronounced increase of 1.1 per cent.	 2.6% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the prices under Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics division increased by 2.6 per cent.
Clothing and Footwear		
 0.1%	Women's suits saw a slight decline of 0.2 per cent, while Kanga/Kikoi recorded a larger drop of 0.6 per cent. In contrast, men's trousers experienced a small price increase of 0.2 per cent over the same period	 2.2% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the prices of items under Clothing and Footwear division rose by 2.2 per cent.
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance		
 0.3%	Between July and August 2026, shoe polish/cream recorded price decrease of 0.3 per cent. In contrast, laundry soap/bar soap and detergents both saw price increases, rising by 0.3 per cent and 0.8 per cent, respectively.	 2.9% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance division inflation rose to 2.9 per cent.
Health		
 0.1%	The price fever and pain relief medications, such as paracetamol, saw a rise by 0.1 per cent. Medicines for cholesterol and blood pressure management increased by 0.2 per cent, while diabetes medications recorded the largest rise at 0.7 per cent.	 2.8% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the prices of items under Health division increased by 2.8 per cent.

#

Monthly	Yearly
Information and Communication	
  0.4% Between July and August 2026, internet costs recorded a marginal increase of 0.1 per cent, while mobile phone airtime rose by 0.4 per cent.	 0.8% The sector recorded a yearly inflation of 0.8 per cent.
Recreation, Sport and Culture	
  1.0% Between July and August 2026, secondary school textbooks recorded a slight price increase of 0.3 per cent, while entry fees for museums, game parks, and historical sites rose sharply by 5.5 per cent.	 3.6% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the Recreation, Sport and Culture division index went up by 3.6 per cent.
Education Services	
  0.0% Education index remained constant during the period.	 2.9% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the index for the Education division increased by 3.1 per cent.
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	
  0.2% Between July and August 2026, lodging and guest expenses rose by 0.2 per cent, while hotel boarding costs saw a smaller increase of 0.1 per cent. Food from vendor rose by 0.8 per cent.	 3.0% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the index for the Restaurants and Accommodation Services division rose by 2.9 per cent.
Insurance and Financial Services	
  0.4% Between July and August 2026, mobile money transfer charges recorded a notable increase of 1.5 per cent.	 1.2% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the prices under Insurance and Financial Services division went up by 0.8 per cent.
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services	
  0.2% Between July and August 2026, toothpaste/mouthwash rose by 0.3 per cent, while body lotion saw a slightly larger increase of 0.6 per cent. Toilet paper/tissue paper increased by 1.3 per cent.	 2.4% Over the twelve months until August 2026, the index for the Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services division increased by 2.7 per cent.

#

Movement of National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities

Table 3 shows movement of national average retail prices of selected commodities. Between July and August 2026, the price of 2 Kg packet of sifted maize flour fell from KSh 157.15 to KSh 152.89. Similarly, price of one litre of cooking (salad) oil eased slightly from KSh 358.09 to KSh 356.72, and while price of one kilogramme of loose maize grain edged down from KSh 72.45 to KSh 72.23. In contrast, price of 2 Kg packet

of white wheat flour rose from KSh 172.98 to KSh 173.35, while price of a kilogramme of beef with bones increased more noticeably, from KSh 768.34 to KSh 777.36.

Electricity costs edged upward for both consumption bands, with a 200 kWh bill rising from KSh 5,648.30 to KSh 5,658.80, and a 50 kWh bill increasing from KSh 1,286.84 to KSh 1,289.47. Diesel, however, became notably cheaper, falling from KSh 224.04 to KSh 219.04 per litre, a decline of about KSh 5.00, while petrol prices remained unchanged at KSh 214.95 per litre.

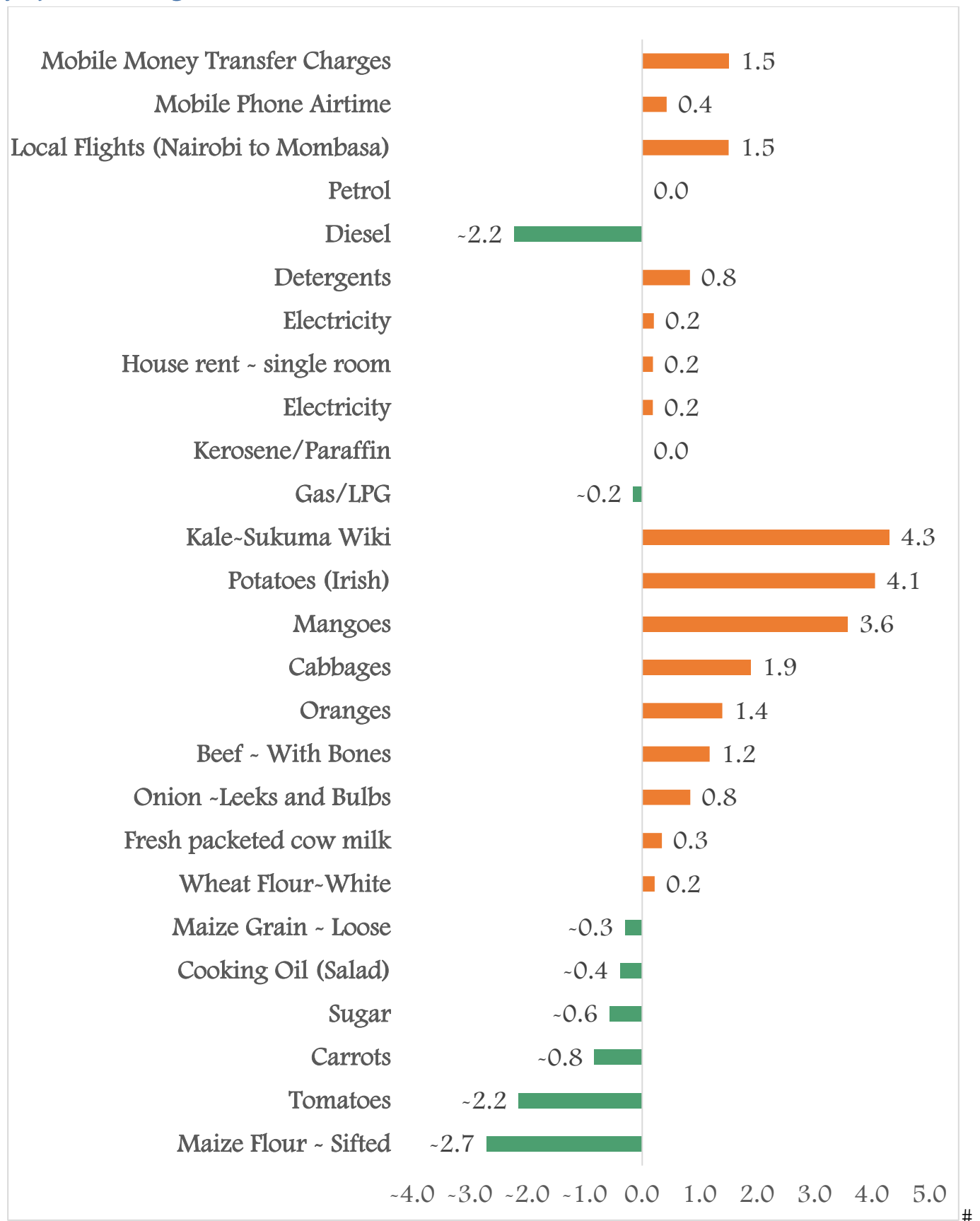
Table 3: National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities

Commodity Name	Quantity	Unit of Measure	Average Price August 2025	Average Price July 2026	Average Price August 2026	% Change over last month August 2026/ July 2026	% Change over last year August 2026/ August 2025
Maize Flour - Sifted	2	Kg	156.99	157.15	152.89	-2.7	-2.6
Tomatoes	1	Kg	85.88	113.47	111.03	-2.2	29.3
Carrots	1	Kg	131.21	140.11	138.95	-0.8	5.9
Sugar	1	Kg	186.53	167.41	166.45	-0.6	-10.8
Cooking Oil (Salad)	1	Litre	343.60	358.09	356.72	-0.4	3.8
Maize Grain - Loose	1	Kg	70.93	72.45	72.23	-0.3	1.8
Wheat Flour-White	2	Kg	170.09	172.98	173.35	0.2	1.9
Fresh packeted cow milk	500	Millilitre	56.29	57.55	57.74	0.3	2.6
Onion -Leeks and Bulbs	1	Kg	108.37	119.37	120.37	0.8	11.1
Beef - With Bones	1	Kg	693.59	768.34	777.36	1.2	12.1
Oranges	1	Kg	104.95	122.98	124.69	1.4	18.8
Cabbages	1	Kg	61.25	73.14	74.52	1.9	21.7
Mangoes	1	Kg	142.97	150.19	155.56	3.6	8.8
Potatoes (Irish)	1	Kg	88.96	113.46	118.05	4.1	32.7
Kale-Sukuma Wiki	1	Kg	93.41	116.22	121.21	4.3	29.8
Gas/LPG	13	Kg	3,158.35	3,432.21	3,426.89	-0.2	8.5
Kerosene/Paraffin	1	Litre	156.76	192.56	192.56	0.0	22.8
Electricity	200	kWh	5,539.54	5,648.30	5,658.80	0.2	2.2
House rent - single room	1	Month	4,184.76	4,225.93	4,233.85	0.2	1.2
Electricity	50	kWh	1,259.65	1,286.84	1,289.47	0.2	2.4
Detergents	500	Gram	242.16	252.70	254.80	0.8	5.2
Diesel	1	Litre	172.75	224.04	219.04	-2.2	26.8
Petrol	1	Litre	186.37	214.95	214.95	0.0	15.3
Local Flights (Nairobi to Mombasa)	1	Return Ticket	29,000.00	26,600.00	27,000.00	1.5	-6.9
Mobile Phone Airtime	1	Per minute	2.43	2.44	2.45	0.4	0.7
Mobile Money Transfer Charges	1	Service	15.47	15.47	15.71	1.5	1.5

#

#

Figure 5: Percentage Change in National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities, July 2026 – August 2026



Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation

Core inflation is a measure of inflation that is compiled from commodities whose prices are non-volatile such as manufactured food items, health services, education services, and ICT. Core inflation increased to 3.4 per cent in August 2026, as presented in Table 4. Non-core inflation was 14.7 per cent during the same period.

Table 4: Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation

Period	Core Index	Core Inflation	Non-Core Index	Non-Core Inflation
Aug-25	129.57	3.0	213.85	9.2
Sep-25	129.52	2.9	215.78	9.6
Oct-25	129.56	2.7	216.87	9.9
Nov-25	129.66	2.3	217.54	10.1
Dec-25	130.09	2.0	220.84	11.2
Jan-26	130.60	2.2	223.74	10.3
Feb-26	130.72	2.1	224.68	10.1
Mar-26	131.07	2.1	227.82	10.8
Apr-26	132.10	2.8	234.61	13.4
May-26	133.16	3.2	242.75	16.0
Jun-26	133.52	3.1	243.17	15.1
Jul-26	133.80	3.2	243.34	15.0
Aug-26	134.01	3.4	245.39	14.7

#

Contribution of Core and Non-Core to the Overall Inflation

Contribution of core and non-core inflation to the overall inflation is presented in Table 5. Core inflation contributed 3.9 points, while non-core inflation contributed 2.7 points to the overall inflation in August 2026. Food and non-alcoholic beverages contributed to 2.6 points to the overall inflation during the same period.

#

Table 5: Core and Non-Core Contributions, August 2026

Broad Categories	Core	Non Core	Total
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	0.8	1.8	2.6
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	0.1	~	0.1
Clothing and Footwear	0.2	~	0.2
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	0.2	0.4	0.6
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household	0.3	~	0.3
Health	0.2	~	0.2
Transport	1.0	0.5	1.5
Information and Communication	0.1	~	0.1
Recreation, Sport and Culture	0.1	~	0.1
Education Services	0.2	~	0.2
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	0.3	~	0.3
Insurance and Financial Services	0.1	~	0.1
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods	0.2	~	0.2
Total	3.9	2.7	6.6



Macdonald G. Obudho, PhD, EBS, MBS
DIRECTOR GENERAL

#